

WFP SUDAN

COUNTRY BRIEF

May 2026



3.1 million people assisted in April 2026



26,700 mt food distributed in April 2026



USD 13 million cash transferred in April 2026



USD 578.7 required in the next six months (May-October 2026)

SITUATION OVERVIEW

- On 2 April, the Office of the RC/HC relocated to Khartoum following the recent re-establishment of government ministries. WFP Sudan is implementing a phased return to Khartoum and rotations supported by the regular UNHAS airbridge.
- 15 April 2026 marked the third anniversary of the war in Sudan. In a [statement](#), the UN Secretary-General warned that Sudan has become the world's largest humanitarian crisis and urged an immediate ceasefire, civilian protection, full funding for aid, and a credible civilian-led political process.
- At the Berlin Conference on 15 April, donors [pledged](#) over USD 1.5 billion to Sudan.
- On 24 April, a truck carrying relief items from UNHCR came under [drone attack](#) in North Darfur, destroying emergency shelter supplies intended for 1,300 families in Tawila, where more than 700,000 displaced people have sought safety after fleeing fighting in other parts of Darfur.

KEY HIGHLIGHTS

- Since the beginning of 2026, WFP has been unable to achieve the monthly average reach of 2025 (4 million). The decrease in reach has been driven by funding shortages, access constraints, and administrative delays.
- In April, 798,000 people were reached in areas projected to be already facing or at risk of catastrophic hunger (IPC phase 4-5) covering 62 percent of the 1.3 million food-insecure population in those locations.
- Out of the 3.1 million people assisted in April, WFP reached 2.9 million crisis-affected people with food and cash assistance.
- WFP also reached 1.1 million people through CBT in April.
- WFP provided integrated nutrition support to 203,000 people, including children under five and pregnant and breastfeeding women and girls (PBWG).
- In Tawila, North Darfur, home to the largest population of internally displaced persons (IDPs), WFP delivered life-saving emergency food and nutrition assistance to more than 450,000 people.
- From 8 to 14 April, WFP Deputy Executive Director Carl Skau undertook a high-level mission to Sudan. The mission focused on engagement with government authorities, the reestablishment of WFP's presence in Khartoum, and a review of operational conditions in Darfur and key border areas.

OPERATIONAL CHALLENGES

- In April, WFP reached fewer beneficiaries than planned, due to a combination of challenges including acute funding shortfalls, active conflict and bureaucratic impediments.
- In 2026 thus far, the CO has received USD 87.2 million, just 13 percent of funding received during the same period in 2025, significantly constraining the scale and continuity of operations.
- Active conflict and reoccurring drone strikes have prevented WFP from reaching people in the Kordofan and Darfur regions. This has resulted in a lack of WFP assistance for certain vulnerable populations. This includes Kornoi and Um Baru in North Darfur, two locations that have surpassed famine thresholds for Global Acute Malnutrition (GAM). This also includes Dilling (Risk of Famine Location) and Kadugli (Famine Location) in South Kordofan.
- This continued insecurity in greater Kordofan has resulted in WFP being unable to reach West Kordofan, such as Al Lagowa and As Sunut, two risk of famine locations, with in-kind assistance since the start of 2026.
- Over the past two months, delays in HAC approvals have substantially constrained WFP distributions. In April, 2,600 mt of food commodities remain pending movement clearance in Al Dabbah and Dongola, impacting assistance to 300,000 people, delaying WFP's April distribution cycle across North Darfur, East Darfur, South Darfur, and Khartoum. Negotiations with the authorities are ongoing.
- In addition, the impact of the Middle East Crisis is causing disruptions to maritime corridors which is stalling food, fuel and fertilizer imports, straining fragile supply chains, inflating delivery costs and constraining humanitarian operations.
- The security situation remained volatile, with drone strikes in North Kordofan and clashes along the Dilling–Kadugli route disrupting key corridors and supply movements.
- At the same time, insecurity and inflation, including a reported 300% increase in sorghum prices in parts of South Kordofan, reduced both food availability and affordability.
- Market disruptions impacted physical access to food and purchasing power was constrained. In response, in-kind food assistance was critical where markets broke down or access was blocked, while cash-based transfers (CBT) was effective where food was available but unaffordable.
- WFP's Shock-Responsive Emergency Safety Net programme reached 28,000 people with CBT in North Kordofan, where households are facing prolonged shocks.
- In addition, under WFP's crisis response, 22,000 people in North and South Kordofan were reached with CBT in April. WFP also managed to reach 200 beneficiaries with CBT in West Kordofan (Al Lagowa and As Sunut), two risk of famine locations.
- To mitigate the impact of Moderate Acute Malnutrition (MAM) in the Kordofans, WFP reached 11,000 children and pregnant and breastfeeding woman and girls (PBWG) supporting the treatment of MAM in North and South Kordofan. WFP also provided emergency blanket supplementary feeding for 270 individuals in Kortala, South Kordofan, a risk of famine location.

Greater Darfur

- In April, WFP sustained large-scale operations across the Darfurs reaching 1.4 million people (Central Darfur 271,000; East Darfur 88,000; North Darfur 682,000; South Darfur 70,000; and West Darfur 237,000). 1.1 million people were reached with in-kind food assistance and 180,000 people were reached with CBT.
- The conditions in the Darfurs reflect a collapse of livelihoods and limited market functionality in many areas, meaning food is often physically unavailable. This has made WFP's large-scale in-kind assistance essential, particularly in IPC 4+ locations.
- WFP reached 457,000 IDPs in Tawila as well as 6,000 people in El Fasher, a famine-affected area.

OPERATIONAL UPDATES

Greater Kordofan

- In April, active conflict affected supply routes resulting in prolonged convoy delays in the Kordofans. Despite this, WFP reached 387,000 people (North Kordofan 235,000; South Kordofan 152,000; and West Kordofan 200) across the Kordofans this month. 324,000 people were reached with in-kind food assistance and 50,000 people were reached with CBT.

- At the same time, where markets remain partially functional, CBT is supporting access by restoring purchasing power. WFP is beginning preparations to transition from in-kind assistance to CBT in areas of North Darfur. Large-scale registration and digitization commenced in April. This is being followed by a pilot in Tawila which is targeting 100,000 beneficiaries in May.
- Additionally, 177,000 people in West Darfur were supported through WFP's Shock-Responsive Emergency Safety Net programme, helping mitigate the impacts of conflict, displacement, and economic shocks while strengthening resilience and access to basic services.
- Given high malnutrition rates in the Darfurs and large inflows of displaced populations arriving in poor nutritional condition, nutrition support remains a critical life-saving intervention. WFP reached 37,000 children and PBWG, supporting the treatment of MAM across all Darfur states.

Khartoum

- In April, WFP reached 160,000 people in Khartoum. 7,000 people were reached with in-kind food assistance and 65,000 people were reached with CBT through WFP's Shock-Responsive Emergency Safety Net programme.
- The operating environment remains fragile, with delays in food deliveries from Dongola and Al Dabbah and fuel shortages affecting operations in the state.
- Food security has improved from peak conflict levels in Khartoum, but remains constrained by large-scale returns, limited infrastructure and slow economic recovery. Food is available in markets, but many households *cannot afford it*. *WFP is responding to the situation by providing critical in-kind assistance to 59,000 people.*
- *In parallel, 35,000 children and PBWG received support for the treatment for MAM, ensuring continued access to essential nutrition services.*

Northeast Sudan

- Northeast Sudan hosts large, displaced populations and faces growing economic pressure.
- In April, WFP reached 945,000 people in Northeast Sudan (Gedaref 85,000; Kassala 215,000; Northern 116,000; Red Sea 24,000; River Nile 132,000 and White Nile 373,000). 59,000 people were reached with in-kind food assistance and 754,000 people were reached with CBT.



Photo: WFP Country Director at Tractor Handover in Dongola, Northern State. @WFP/Abubakar Garelnabel

- April was marked by increasing fuel and commodity prices, as well as delays in truck clearances in Northern State. Despite this, WFP reached 114,000 people with in-kind food assistance.
- Markets remained generally functioning in the region in April, allowing for WFP's Shock-Responsive Emergency Safety Net programme to reach 272,000 people through CBT, to be effective in restoring access to food and supporting local economies.
- Emergency cash assistance also scaled up in White Nile, where CBPF funding enabled the rollout of cash-based assistance, reaching over 320,000 people.
- WFP's nutrition response reached 67,000 children and PBWG to support the treatment of MAM, alongside 23,000 beneficiaries through Food-Based Prevention of Malnutrition (FBPM). Nutrition assistance included 47,000 people reached in Northern State, 35,000 in River Nile, 14,000 in Gedaref, 11,000 in Kassala, and 6,000 in White Nile.
- A key feature of the Northeast region is the role of resilience programming, particularly in agriculture, which supports local food production and reduces long-term dependence on humanitarian assistance.
- In April, WFP advanced resilience efforts through support to food systems transformations. Based on identified needs, under the Sudan Emergency Wheat Production Project, WFP is supporting smallholder farmers with their harvests by procuring 28 tractors for three states. By the end of April, 12 tractors were delivered in Northern State, with the remaining tractors to be distributed in the upcoming months in River Nile and Gezira. Following the completion of the

harvest expected in May 2026, these tractors will be used by farmers to prepare for the next harvest season.

Southern Sudan

- WFP sustained both lifesaving and resilience programming in April, reaching 237,000 people (Gezira 62,000 and Blue Nile 176,000) with assistance. 152,000 people were reached with in-kind food assistance and 32,000 people were reached with CBT.
- In the Southern States, WFP is both addressing immediate food needs while reducing future vulnerability.
- In conflict-affected areas such as Blue Nile, access constraints and disrupted markets require continued in-kind food assistance. In April, WFP reached 152,000 people with in-kind food assistance, primarily in Blue Nile.
- Additionally, a total of 53,000 children and PBWG received support for the treatment of MAM in Blue Nile and Gezira states.
- In more stable and agriculturally viable areas such as Gezira, WFP implements resilience-focused programming. In April, WFP reached 13,000 people in Gezira through Food for Assets (FFA), contributing to livelihood recovery and community asset creation.

VOICES FROM THE FIELD



Entesar returned home to find nothing. With no money or livelihood, her family ate once a day. Through SANAD, Sudan's emergency safety-net, financed by the World Bank, WFP is delivering monthly cash support to food-insecure households.

*"Before, everything we wanted to eat was within reach, now you go the shop and leave without buying anything. This assistance has helped me buy food from the shop and pay my debts
SANAD helps families meet essential needs while protecting human capital.*

CLUSTER AND COMMON SERVICES

Logistics Cluster (LC)

- During the month, the Logistics Cluster received 1,181 m3 of humanitarian relief supplies at key common storage hubs in Tawila, Ad Dabbah, Kosti, Gedaref, and Port Sudan, representing a 142 percent increase compared to the previous month. Items included shelter, nutrition, education, protection, WASH, and health supplies, supporting 12 partners.
- In April, common storage capacity in Tawila, North Darfur was nearly doubled – from 880m² to 1,600m² – enabling partners to pre-position multi-sectoral relief supplies ahead of the rainy season.
- Through common transport services, the Logistics Cluster supported the movement of five trucks carrying 30 mt (101 m3) of relief supplies, including protection and health items, on behalf of two partners.

UN Humanitarian Air Services (UNHAS)

- In April 2026, UNHAS Sudan transported a total of 1,315 passengers and 2.38 metric tons of cargo across six regular destinations.
- A total of 100 flights were operated in support of 79 humanitarian agencies.

Emergency Telecommunications Cluster (ETC)

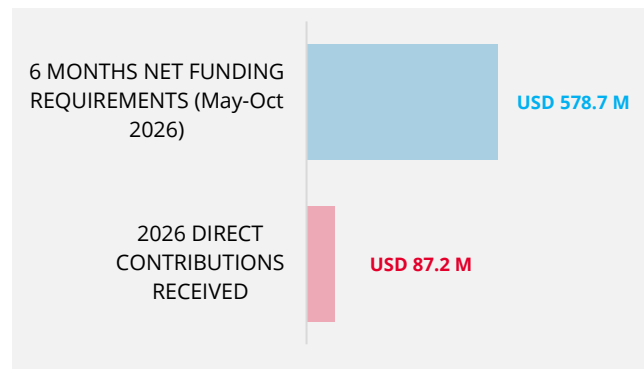
- In April, a total of 67 sites were connected, with the highest concentrations in Port Sudan (39) and Kassala (21), alongside continued services in Kosti, Damazine, Gedaref, Dongola, and Atbara. Approximately 1,700 users relied on the network for essential operational communications.
- ETC and UNDSS carried out a security communications assessment in Khartoum to guide a restoration plan in line with the UN's phased return to Khartoum.

Food Security Cluster (FSC)

- In April, the FSL Cluster members have reached 3.4 million individuals across all 18 states of Sudan, including 2.97 million with food assistance and 461,500 with livelihoods assistance.

FUNDING OVERVIEW

- Severe resource constraints have forced WFP to undertake hyper-prioritization of beneficiaries across its operations. WFP reduced its annual target from 11.5 million people in 2025 to 8.5 million in 2026.
- Without urgent new funding, WFP will be forced to further scale back assistance - potentially reducing support by one million people per month by late 2026, primarily affecting those in the most severe levels of food insecurity (IPC 4+). Immediate funding is required to sustain life-saving assistance and protect critical humanitarian gains.



Contributions Received from Donors as of April 2026:

Canada, Finland, Germany, Iceland, Japan, Lithuania, Sweden, UN Country-Based Pooled Funds and Private Donors.



Photo: Harvest in Dongola, Norther State. @WFP/Abubakar Garelnabel